

Document 7: Library Access & Fine Guidelines

Institution: Hyderabad Institute of Technology (HIT)

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1. Central Library Infrastructure and Operating Hours

The Dr. A.P.J. Abdul Kalam Central Library at the Hyderabad Institute of Technology spans three floors, encompassing over forty thousand square feet of dedicated academic space. The facility is fully automated using an RFID-based Library Management System, providing students with self-issue kiosks, automated drop-boxes for returning materials, and an online public access catalog (OPAC) to track book availability in real-time.

To maximize accessibility, the physical library operates under a dual-timing model that automatically shifts depending on the academic calendar.

- **Standard Semester Timings:** During regular instruction weeks, the library opens at 8:00 AM and closes at 10:00 PM from Monday to Friday. On weekends (Saturday and Sunday), the working hours are condensed to 9:00 AM to 5:00 PM. The circulation desk (where books are officially issued) closes exactly one hour before the library shuts down.
- **Examination Period Timings:** Recognizing the intense pressure of end-semester assessments, the library initiates its "Night Owl" schedule beginning two weeks prior to the first final exam. During this period, the reading halls on the ground and first floors remain open until 2:00 AM, seven days a week. However, book issuance and return services are suspended at 8:00 PM during the exam phase.

Entry to the library requires a mandatory biometric scan or physical scanning of the university ID card at the turnstile gates. The ID card is non-transferable. If a student is caught handing their ID card to a non-university friend to grant them access to the

library, the student will face an immediate ₹2,000 fine and a one-month suspension of all borrowing privileges.

2. Tiered Circulation Policy and Borrowing Privileges

The university allocates borrowing privileges based on the academic seniority of the patron to ensure that final-year students executing major research projects have access to a higher volume of reference materials.

A student must physically present their own ID card at the circulation desk or self-issue kiosk. Books cannot be issued on behalf of a roommate or classmate under any circumstances.

- **Freshman and Sophomore Limits (1st and 2nd Year B.Tech):** Junior undergraduate students are authorized to borrow a maximum of four physical books simultaneously. The standard lending duration for this tier is exactly fourteen calendar days.
- **Junior and Senior Limits (3rd and 4th Year B.Tech):** Recognizing their specialized elective requirements, senior undergraduate students can borrow a maximum of six physical books simultaneously. Their lending duration remains fourteen calendar days.
- **Postgraduate and Research Scholars (M.Tech/Ph.D.):** Graduate students are permitted to borrow up to ten books simultaneously. Due to the deep research nature of their work, their lending duration is extended to thirty calendar days.

The Renewal Protocol: If a student requires a book beyond the standard lending period, they may request a digital renewal through the student portal. A book can be renewed a maximum of two consecutive times (granting an additional 28 days for B.Tech students). However, a renewal request will be automatically rejected by the system if another student has placed a "Hold" or "Reservation" on that specific title. In such cases, the book must be returned by the original due date.

3. Escalating Fine Structure for Overdue Materials

The library strictly enforces its return deadlines to ensure that high-demand textbooks circulate efficiently among the massive student body. Late returns deprive other students of necessary educational resources, and as such, the library system automatically levies escalating daily fines the moment a book becomes overdue.

Fines are calculated precisely from midnight of the printed due date. The system operates 24/7; therefore, weekends and national holidays are actively counted when calculating late days.

- **Tier 1 Penalty (Days 1 to 5):** For the first five days immediately following the due date, a nominal fine of ₹10 per book, per day is applied.
- **Tier 2 Penalty (Days 6 to 15):** From the sixth day onwards, the fine escalates sharply to ₹25 per book, per day.
- **Tier 3 Penalty (Day 16 onwards):** If a book is retained for more than fifteen days past its due date, the student's library account is instantly frozen. They cannot borrow new books, renew existing ones, or access the digital library portal. The fine continues to accrue at ₹50 per book, per day until the item is surrendered to the circulation desk.

Students cannot clear their library dues using cash. All accumulated fines must be paid digitally through the campus payment gateway integrated into the student portal. A "No Dues" certificate, which is mandatory for receiving the final degree, will not be issued if there is even a single rupee outstanding in the student's library ledger.

4. Damaged, Defaced, and Lost Book Regulations

Students are expected to inspect books for missing pages or torn bindings before issuing them. If a defect is found, it must be reported to the librarian immediately to be noted in the system. If a student returns a book that has been heavily highlighted, annotated with a pen, or subjected to liquid damage, the library considers the book destroyed.

In the event that a student permanently loses a library book or destroys it, they must adhere to the Replacement Protocol.

- **Primary Resolution:** The student must purchase a brand-new copy of the exact same title, author, and publisher. The replacement must be the identical edition or a newer edition; older editions are strictly rejected. Along with the replacement book, the student must pay a non-refundable administrative processing fee of ₹500 to cover the cost of generating new RFID tags and catalog barcodes.
- **Secondary Resolution (Out of Print):** If the lost book is rare or officially out of print and cannot be purchased in the open market, the student is legally obligated to pay a massive penalty equivalent to three times the original printed price of the book. If the book was imported and priced in a foreign currency, the conversion rate on the day of the fine payment will be utilized.

Tampering with the RFID security tags glued to the inside back cover of every book is considered a severe act of vandalism. Any student caught trying to peel off the RFID tag to bypass the security gates will be fined ₹5,000 and suspended from the library for the remainder of the semester.

5. Digital E-Resource Access and Usage Restrictions

HIT subscribes to premium international databases, including IEEE Xplore, SpringerLink, ACM Digital Library, and Elsevier ScienceDirect, spending millions of rupees annually to provide students with cutting-edge research.

Access to these premium databases is strictly IP-restricted. Students can access full-text PDFs only when connected to the official campus Wi-Fi network (HIT-SECURE). Off-campus access is routed through a specialized proxy server, which requires the student's university email credentials and Two-Factor Authentication (2FA) via the mobile app.

While the university encourages deep research, it strictly prohibits systematic or automated downloading.

- **The Anti-Scraping Policy:** If a student's account is detected downloading more than fifty PDF research papers within a single sixty-minute window, the university's firewall algorithms will flag the activity as "Bulk Scraping."
- **Consequences of Bulk Scraping:** The student's digital library access will be instantly and automatically revoked by the server. Furthermore, international publishers like IEEE hold the right to block the entire university's IP address if they detect malicious crawling. Therefore, a student responsible for triggering an institutional block will face a disciplinary committee hearing and a potential fine of up to ₹10,000 for jeopardizing the university's academic standing.

6. Property Deposit and Silence Zone Protocols

To prevent theft and maintain a purely academic environment, the Central Library enforces strict rules regarding personal belongings and internal conduct.

Students are entirely prohibited from bringing their personal backpacks, messenger bags, or printed textbooks from outside into the main circulation areas. All personal bags must be deposited in the Baggage Drop Zone located in the ground floor lobby. Students are only permitted to carry their laptops (without the carrying case), loose sheets of paper, pens, and valuables like wallets and phones into the reading halls. The university takes absolutely no responsibility for cash or electronics left unattended in the Baggage Drop Zone.

The entire second floor of the library is designated as an Absolute Silence Zone. Group discussions, project planning, and even whispered conversations are banned on this floor. If a student needs to conduct a group study session, they must utilize the Collaborative Discussion Rooms located on the ground floor, which can be booked for a maximum of two hours via the library app. If the roaming floor librarian catches a student talking loudly, playing audio without headphones, or taking a phone call in the Absolute Silence Zone, they will immediately confiscate the student's ID card and force them to leave the building for the day.